

Vendor Review — August 10, 2026

Attendees: Bala, Neeraj

Bala: You look rough.

Neeraj: Thank you Bala, very kind. I was up late dealing with a platform incident. Memory leak in one of the background jobs. Everything's fine now but it took a while to track down.

Bala: Ah, I missed the alert. Glad it's resolved. Write it up at some point so we have a record.

Neeraj: I'll do it this afternoon. What are we here for?

Bala: Analytics vendor. The contract renews September 30th and finance is asking hard questions about the forty thousand dollar price tag.

Neeraj: Forty thousand? I knew it was expensive but I didn't realise it was that much.

Bala: Forty thousand a year. And beyond the cost I've been hearing complaints about data latency. You've noticed it too right?

Neeraj: The dashboards can be twenty minutes behind. I've had to tell people not to trust the real-time view more than once, which defeats the entire purpose.

Bala: Exactly. So I don't want to auto-renew without at least looking around. But I also can't do a six-week evaluation project right before Q4, that would be insane.

Neeraj: Quick structured comparison?

Bala: Three vendors, rough pros and cons, something I can take to finance. Can you put that together by August 17th?

Neeraj: Yes. I'm thinking Mixpanel, Amplitude, and PostHog. PostHog is open source, could dramatically cut costs if we're okay self-hosting.

Bala: Self-hosting sounds like it comes with its own headaches.

Neeraj: It can. But worth including in the comparison so finance sees we considered the full range of options. August 17th for the shortlist.

Bala: Good. Before you write that up though, can you pull a usage report from the current platform? Their admin panel shows feature adoption. I have a feeling we're paying for things nobody has touched in a year.

Neeraj: Almost certainly. I can get that to you by Wednesday August 13th. Helps me write a better comparison anyway if I know what we're actually using.

Bala: August 13th, perfect. And I should actually read the contract before we have any of these conversations with finance or vendors. I keep assuming I know what's in it.

Neeraj: Especially the notice period. If we decide to switch we need to know whether we've already missed the cancellation window.

Bala: Good point. I'll read through the full contract and flag anything that looks different from last year. I'll do that by August 14th. Okay, what else. Our current data pipeline, the way we're sending events to the vendor, it's a bit of a mess. Whoever set it up originally used three different methods and it's inconsistent. Even if we stay with the current vendor we should clean it up. Can you document how events are currently being sent so we at least know what we're dealing with?

Neeraj: Yeah I've been meaning to do that for a while. I'll put together an event tracking audit document by August 20th. It'll also be useful if we do switch vendors, we'll know exactly what needs to be migrated.

Bala: Exactly, it's useful either way. Now, on the vendor evaluation, I want someone from the data team to weigh in too since they use the dashboards most. Can you set up a thirty minute call with them this week to get their list of must-haves and pain points before you write the comparison? That way the shortlist reflects what the actual users need, not just what engineering thinks they need.

Neeraj: Good idea. I'll set that up before Friday August 14th.

Bala: Thanks. I should also get on a call with our current account manager. Sometimes there's negotiating room that isn't in the renewal notice, especially if they know we're evaluating alternatives.

Neeraj: Worth doing even if we end up switching. They might surprise you.

Bala: I'll set that up and have the call done before August 25th. And once you've sent me the vendor shortlist I'll put together a recommendation document for the board. They'll want to know the rationale before we commit to anything. I'll have that ready by August 21st.

Neeraj: That's only four days after my shortlist.

Bala: I work fast when finance is breathing down my neck. Okay, completely different topic. Did you see that Ravi is leaving?

Neeraj: What? When did that happen?

Bala: He announced it Friday afternoon when half the office had already left for the weekend. Classic.

Neeraj: Where's he going?

Bala: Some startup in Berlin. He seems genuinely excited about it.

Neeraj: Good for him. We should do something before he goes.

Bala: HR is sorting something out I think. Alright, I'll let you get back to it. Write up that incident report first, don't forget.

Neeraj: Already on my list.